without settling the issue of the India-China frontier and the Chinese annexation of Aksai Chin to build the road linking Sinkiang and Tibet.

In 1959, the Pakistani Government became concerned over Chinese maps that included areas the Pakistanis considered their own. While Pakistan's President Ayub Khan persisted in his efforts towards an Indo-Pakistani military rapprochement, he started pursuing a policy of revisiting the Chinese frontier claims. If China did not intend to penetrate the Karakoram barrier and intrude into the territory of West Pakistan, there would be a diplomatic advantage in establishing closer relations with Beijing. The first overtures to China began in 1959 and led to an agreement between Pakistan and China to construct the Karakoram Highway, also known as the Friendship Highway. The survey of the physical route started in 1959 and the highway traversed through the Gilgit Agency. It became apparent that unlike India, China was offering Pakistan a hand of friendship and in return wanted a part of the Gilgit Agency, specifically the Shaksgam Valley, which Pakistan had annexed from the erstwhile ruler of Jammu and Kashmir. What China sought from Pakistan was a settled border, just as it did with its other neighbours like Nepal, Burma and the Mongolian People's Republic. Thus, on 15 January 1961, the Pakistan Foreign Minister, Manzur Qadir, was able to announce that Pakistan and China had agreed, in principle, to demarcate their common border. This border, of course, ran through places that were all a part of the erstwhile state of Jammu and Kashmir, which Pakistan had annexed in 1947–48.